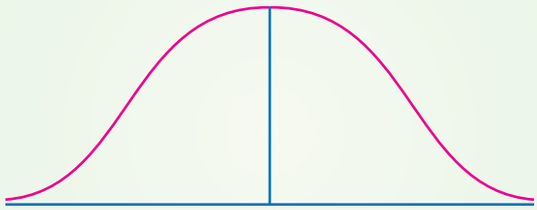
(a) Symmetrical Distribution

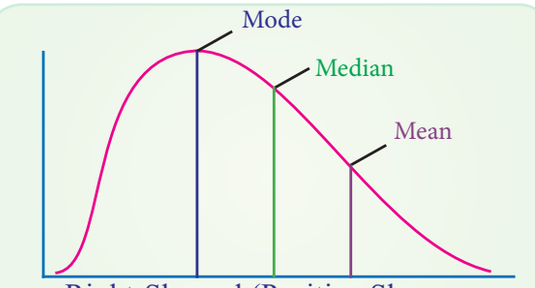
It is clear from the diagram below that in a symmetrical distribution the values of mean, median and mode coincide. The spread of the frequencies is the same on both sides of the centre point of the curve.



Mean = Median = Mode
Fig.6.1

(b) Positively Skewed Distribution

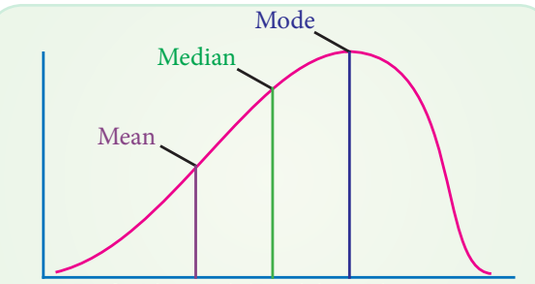
In the positively skewed distribution the value of the mean is maximum and that of mode is least – the median lies in between the two. In the positively skewed distribution the frequencies are spread out over a greater range of values on the high-value end of the curve (the right-hand side) than they are on the low – value end. For a positively skewed distribution, Mean>Median> Mode



Right-Skewed (Positive Skewness
Fig.6.2

(c) Negatively skewed distribution

In a negatively skewed distribution the value of mode is maximum and that of mean least-the median lies in between the two. In the negatively skewed distribution the position is reversed, i.e., the excess tail is on the left-hand side.



Left-Skewed (Positive Skewness
Fig.6.3

It should be noted that in moderately symmetrical distribution the interval between the mean and the median is approximately one-third of the interval between the mean and the mode. It is this relationship which provides a means of measuring the degree of skewness.

d. Some important Measures of Skewness

(i) Karl-Pearson coefficient of skewness

(ii) Bowley's coefficient of skewness

(iii) Coefficient of skewness based on moments

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